7.6.1 Validating Kubernetes manifests in the commit stage

Throughout this chapter, we've worked with resource manifests for creating Deployments and Services in a Kubernetes cluster. A *manifest* is "a specification of a Kubernetes API object in JSON or YAML format." It specifies "the desired state of an object that Kubernetes will maintain when you apply the manifest" (https://kubernetes.io/docs/reference/glossary).

Since a manifest specifies the desired state of an object, we should ensure that our specification complies with the API exposed by Kubernetes. It's a good idea to automate this validation in the commit stage of a deployment pipeline to get fast feedback in case of errors (rather than waiting until the acceptance stage, where we need to use those manifests to deploy the application in a Kubernetes cluster). Figure 7.15 illustrates the main steps of the commit stage after including the validation of Kubernetes manifests.